Week 11 / Thursday

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Accessibility

The degree to which disabled people are able to access the information encoded in a document, environment, service, etc.

Universal Design

The argument that documents, environments, services, etc. should be designed in a way that makes them universally accessible to ALL people, and that doing so not only promotes access but increases their quality.

Alt Text

- “Alternative text”
- Provides descriptions of images “behind the scenes”

Alt Text: Best Practices

- Short (1-2 sentences)
- Descriptive

Alt Text: Rhetorical Considerations

- Context-based
- Audience-aware
- Purpose-driven

Writing Alt Text

For the image on the next slide, how would we write a alt text...

- For a page about Midwest colleges?
- For a page about colleges going remote during a pandemic?
- For a page about beautification efforts on campus?

Writing Alt Text



Figure: Our wonderful campus.

Try it Yourself

Choose a (class-appropriate) photo in your phone. Imagine two different contexts in which you'd share it. Then, write alt text you would include for it in each of those situations.

Where to Use Alt Text?

Nearly every platform that incorporates images provides a way to include alt text.

Heading Structures

- Logical outlines of content
- Structures of “chunked” information
- Signals of the relationships between ideas

Heading Structures



Figure: An example of a nested heading structure.

Why Heading Structures?

- Accessibility
- Composition
- Document styling
- Collaboration

Best Practices for Heading Structures

- Include only one “top-level” header.
- Don’t skip levels.

Poor Headings

Heading Level 1

—— Heading Level 3

Heading Level 1

— Heading Level 2

——— Heading Level 4

Effective Headings

Heading Level 1

— Heading Level 2

— Heading Level 2

—— Heading Level 3

——— Heading Level 4